

Develop Smart Client Applications

Visual Studio 2008 provides developers with new ways to build smart clients that enhance the functionality of the application, in addition to improving developer productivity. Many customers face the challenge of integrating their smart client applications with existing and new Web based applications through logon and personalization services. Visual Studio provides a new set of tools and classes that simplify this integration and enable developers to simply handle the local caching of data for disconnected scenarios.

Smart client development areas of focus include:

- *Integrated UI designer experience*
 - *By supporting common formats (such as XAML) and giving designers more direct control over the layout, controls, and data binding of the application user interface (UI), Visual Studio makes integrating designers into the development process easier. Designers can use familiar tools like the Microsoft® Expression® Suite to create UIs and produce files that developers can work with directly in Visual Studio. Visual Studio supports a fully collaborative workflow that enables designers and developers to hand work back and forth directly and work in parallel. Designers and developers will also be able to build libraries of common UI designs, formats, and elements that can be easily managed and reused.*
 - *By taking advantage of the 2007 Office system as a development platform, designers can leverage the look and feel of both Office and SharePoint to create familiar, intuitive UI. Developers can then use Visual Studio Tools for Office to create the UI in their solutions quickly and easily.*
- *Improved ClickOnce application deployment*
 - *ClickOnce deployment in Visual Studio 2005 provided Web like deployment for smart clients. Users could go to a single URL and click a link to have the smart client application installed on their machine. IT Professionals could deploy new versions of the application by simply copying the new application to the URL. In Visual Studio 2008, ClickOnce now supports Firefox® as a browser and provides location independent signing and customer branding. In addition, ClickOnce now supports deployment through authenticated proxy servers and enables developers to distribute their application to multiple end-user companies from a central location.*
- *Office 2007 UI style support for native C++ applications*
 - *Visual Studio 2008 also provides developers with support for building applications that use the Microsoft Office 2007 UI style, including the Ribbon Bar, Ribbon Status Bar, and Mini-toolbar.*
- *Client Application-Level Services*
 - *Enable client application developers to use the same user profile and login services as their Web applications. This enables customers to use one method of backend storage for user personalization and authentication, regardless of the application type.*